State of New York
Public Service Commission

Case 25-E-0072: Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for Electric Service.

Case 25-G-0073: Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for Gas Service

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DIRECT TESTIMONY OF ERIC BOWERS

ON BEHALF OF THE NEW YORK POWER AUTHORITY

May 30, 2025

INTRODUCTION AND QUALIFICATIONS

Q. Please state your name and business address.

A. My name is Eric Bowers. My business address is 123 Main Street, White Plains, New York 10601.

Q. By whom are you employed, in what capacity, and what are your current responsibilities, and what are your qualifications and professional background?

A. I am employed by the New York Power Authority (NYPA). My current title is Vice President – Economic Development & Key Account Management. I received my undergraduate and graduate degrees from Marist College, graduating in 2002 and 2008 respectively for those degrees. Prior to joining NYPA in 2007, I was employed by the Hudson Valley Federal Credit Union, now Hudson Valley Credit Union, where I served a number of roles such as Financial Service Representative, Branch Supervisor, and Assistant Branch Manager.

My current responsibilities as the Vice President of Economic Development and Key Account Management include oversight of NYPA's power supply portfolio of customers, including but not limited to our Southeastern New York Governmental Customers, NYPA's in-state Municipal and Rural Electric Cooperatives and NYPA's Business customers. I am also responsible for NYPA's Economic Development team, NYPA's Origination & Structuring team, and NYPA's Power Contracts & Tariffs and Business Power Allocations & Compliance teams.

Regarding the Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. ("Con Edison" or "Company"), I interface with Con Edison through our business and not-for-profit customers located within the Con Edison territory as well as our Southeastern New York

Governmental customers in Westchester and New York City. This includes 103 Westchester customers and 11 in New York City.

Q. Have you previously testified or submitted testimony in any regulatory proceeding?

A. No.

PURPOSE AND SUMMARY OF TESTIMONY

Q. Please describe NYPA's interest in this proceeding.

A. NYPA is a corporate municipal instrumentality and political subdivision of New York State whose mission is to provide low cost and reliable electricity consistent with safety and a clean environment, while promoting economic growth, energy efficiency, renewable and innovation for the benefit of its customers. In the Con Edison service territory, NYPA serves approximately 11,000 governmental customer accounts (collectively, the "NYPA Governmental Customers") under long-term supply contracts, whose delivery of power and energy to its electric customers in New York City and Westchester County is provided by Con Edison. These delivery arrangements are contained in the Company's PSC No. 12 tariff applicable to NYPA. NYPA has historically intervened in the Company's rate proceedings to help ensure fair delivery rates for NYPA's customers.

Q. What is the purpose of your testimony?

A. The purpose of my testimony is to identify the areas of concern regarding the Company's direct testimony on customer operations protocols with respect to NYPA Governmental Customers. In its January 2025 Customer Operations Panel ("COP") testimony, the Company proposed establishing "a dedicated group to investigate and resolve all

inquiries from NYPA and NYPA customers, adding process efficiencies and establishing a single point of contact resolution." COP testimony at 41:19-24. The proposed group would contain senior customer service representatives, supervisors, an IT-focused system specialist, a project specialist, and a project manager, and would "manage the monthly NYPA billing process, become well-versed on the complexity of NYPA and governmental agency inquiries, and be trained to handle specialized rate needs." COP testimony at 42:1-4. The purpose of my testimony is also to make recommendations for improvement to these proposals.

Q. What is your overall reaction to the Customer Operations Panel's approach to improving the Company's account management for NYPA and its Governmental Customers?

A. NYPA is highly supportive of this effort. My testimony, based on the Company's responses to certain NYPA Information Requests ("IR"), will make further, more specific recommendations.

Q. In your testimony, will you refer to, or otherwise rely upon, any information produced during the discovery phase of this proceeding?

A. Yes, as indicated, we will refer to, and have relied upon, certain responses to IRs produced during this proceeding. These responses are included in Exhibit __ (EB-1).

Q. Are you sponsoring any additional exhibits?

A. No.

BILLING

Q. What types of problems do NYPA Governmental Customers experience with the Company's current customer services procedures with respect to billing?

A. NYPA Governmental Customers experience several problems, including billing delays and slow response times to requests for estimated reads, which are calculated estimations of customer usage for a particular billing period where an actual meter reading is not available. NYPA Governmental Customers have also experienced issues with non-billing of accounts that lead to large monthly adjustments. The causes of these billing issues include, but are not limited to, broken meters, the failure of the Company's automated metering infrastructure (AMI) connectivity functions, and meter access issues, such as when the Company cannot physically access a meter but fails to relay this issue to NYPA as necessary for NYPA to work with the relevant Governmental Customer to resolve the access issue.

Q. How would the creation of a dedicated NYPA customer operations team at the Company address these concerns?

A. As detailed in the Company's IR response to NYPA Set 5 Question 19, Company employees in new senior customer service representative roles will "review accounts daily" for unbilled and/or estimated billing and will address the "underlying root causes" of billing issues by promoting timely automated billing based on actual meter readings. See Exhibit __ (EB-1) at 3.

Q. Based on the Company's response, what are your recommendations?

A. In view of Con Edison's commitments to address NYPA billing issues in the manner described in this IR response, the Commission should ensure that the Company's

dedicated NYPA account management team achieves its objectives by proactively addressing problems of unbilled accounts (or delayed billing) and problems encountered using estimated meter reading. The Commission should consider establishing benchmarks demonstrating improvement in these areas.

DISTRIBUTED ENERGY RESOURCES

Q. What are the issues that NYPA Governmental Customers experience with the Company's current customer services procedures with respect to distributed energy resource (DER) projects?

A. DER projects must go through the interconnection process in order to connect to the grid. NYPA Governmental Customers often face delays when advancing DER projects because the interconnection process is not streamlined and further hindered by the Company's personnel capacity constraints.

Q. How would the creation of a dedicated NYPA customer operations team at the Company address these concerns?

A. As detailed in the Company's IR response to NYPA Set 5 Question 17, the Company seeks to establish a new managerial role that would oversee the entire interconnection process used to accommodate DER projects, including pre-interconnection activities, assisting with collection and review of necessary forms, inspecting the final setup before granting permission to connect to the grid, and post-interconnection tasks like confirming that the correct account and rate configurations are in place and that the account bills accurately and on time. See Exhibit __ (EB-1) at 1.

NYPA would like to work with the Company to more strategically deploy DER projects in areas of the grid that would be beneficial for the Company to have those assets located and which overlap with our customer sites. Currently, it can be difficult to communicate with the Company regarding placement of these projects, but it is likely that creation of the proposed new managerial role would facilitate this process.

Q. Based on the Company's response, what are your recommendations?

A. Because the Company has indicated its willingness to establish a new managerial role that would oversee the entire interconnection process to accommodate Governmental Customer DER projects and other energy efficiency projects, the Commission should direct the Company to establish benchmarks for achieving these goals.

ELECTRIFICATION WORK

Q. What are the issues that NYPA Governmental Customers experience with the Company's current customer services procedures with respect to electrification work?

A. Electrification efforts of NYPA Governmental Customers have been severely delayed due to service class determination changes and related issues. These efforts include building electrification, such as switching from oil to heat pumps and replacing gas stoves with induction stoves. Many customers are also looking into fleet electrification, including full-fleet bus electrification, and the installation of vehicle charging stations either for customer and/or public use. NYPA sometimes implements these projects on behalf of NYPA Governmental Customers, and other times NYPA Governmental

Customers implement the projects themselves, but significant delays are experienced regardless of the implementing entity.

Q. How would the creation of a dedicated NYPA customer operations team at the Company address these concerns?

A. As detailed in the Company's IR response to NYPA Set 5 Question 18, the Company seeks to create a managerial role that would oversee, among other things, work related to electrification, additional service or load installations, and distributed generation interconnections. This role would serve as a direct line of communication between the customer, engineering, metering groups, and other internal departments to facilitate all stages of the interconnection process including application submittal, service determinations, drawing reviews and rate setting. See Exhibit __ (EB-1) at 2.

Q. Based on the Company's response, what are your recommendations?

A. In addition to the establishment of benchmarks for achieving the Company's goals in supporting NYPA Governmental Customers' electrification efforts, the Company should be encouraged to provide information to NYPA Governmental Customers early and often in the course of an electrification project. Especially for larger electrification projects, NYPA Governmental Customers depend on the Company for information regarding potential grid capacity constraints, and delays by the Company in consulting on siting can result in significant delays to customers' electrification projects.

OTHER ISSUES

Q. Are there other issues that NYPA Governmental Customers experience with the Company's current customer services procedures?

A. Currently, NYPA Governmental Customers lack a single point of contact at the Company and must attempt to communicate with different groups in order to resolve issues. Additional delays are created by back-and-forth between internal divisions of the Company. An example of this issue is NYPA's effort to expand electric vehicle charging with our partners: because some of the chargers are curbside or customer lots that lack an address (such as areas under an overpass), the chargers are classified as a temporary service. This designation requires the customer to pay all of the costs—as much as $250,000. NYPA and its customers have requested the Company reconsider this designation, but as of the date of this testimony NYPA has yet to receive a response.

Q. How would the creation of a dedicated NYPA customer operations team at the Company address these concerns?

A. The Company's proposal (e.g. COP testimony at 41:7-22) to establish a dedicated team for NYPA account management issues is a welcome change. The resolution of these issues would be much more efficient if the proposed new team can operate as a sole point of contact for NYPA Governmental Customers and is empowered to address their concerns by liaising across the Company's different divisions. See IR response to NYPA Set 5 Question 20, Exhibit __ (EB-1) at 4 (detailing coordination work of proposed NYPA account management team).

Q. Does this conclude your testimony?

A. Yes.